

Dear programming educator and researcher

The defining characteristic of the machine that is at the centre of our discipline's topics is that it is programmable. This is reflected in the fact that a large part of the research and teaching in our discipline revolves around programming and programming languages.

Programming is taught at the beginning of most computing courses, and is widely seen as central to computing education. The Joint Task Force on Computing Curricula 2001 (CC2001), following an extensive investigation of computing education practice, stated that "the programming-first model has proven to be extraordinarily durable. [...] The members of the CC2001 Task Force believe that the programming-first model is likely to remain dominant for the foreseeable future."

Despite of this, there is relatively little research and professional exchange in the area of teaching programming on a formal or organised level. Most teachers make their own experiences and develop teaching strategies individually, and an explicit and agreed didactic of programming does not exist as an established field, as it does for some other disciplines. As part of a solution to this, we have established the "Scandinavian Pedagogy of Programming network" (SPoP). This is a rather informal, low overhead group that aims at advancing our field.

The network was established in 2004 and the current participants are from Sweden, Norway, Finland, Denmark and United Kingdom – it is Scandinavia in a broad understanding.☺ We have arranged workshops and the published a book "Reflections on the Teaching of Programming - Methods and Implementations" as Lecture Notes in Computer Science 4821 at Springer-Verlag (see <http://www.springer.com/computer/general/book/978-3-540-77933-9> and <http://www.springerlink.com/content/n767415g323w/?p=fc9e342c0bc846f797a1b9d2e11e3c0c&pi=0>).

We are now in a phase of consolidation and enlargement and would like to

Invite you to our next meeting

Wednesday September 24th, 9.30 – 17.00 at IT University, Copenhagen (www.itu.dk)

We hope that you would like to be a part of the network and will be able to participate in Copenhagen. Further information is available on our web-site www.spop.dk

If you are interested and/or plan to participate, please contact one of the founders by email.

Kind regards

Jens Bennedsen
IT University West
Denmark
jbb@it-vest.dk

Michael Kölling
University of Kent
United Kingdom
mik@kent.ac.uk

Michael E. Caspersen
University of Aarhus
Denmark
mec@daimi.au.dk